

Contact

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Top Skills

Python
Internet of Things (IoT)
Artificial Intelligence

Dewald Scholtz

AI Researcher, Innovator, Maker and Creator at RCT
West Coast, Western Cape, South Africa

Summary

I'm an original Nerd—one of the true ones from the '90s—and I still embrace it. While the term "Nerd" has evolved over time, my world has shifted from knowing "everything about something" to knowing "something about everything." If there's something I don't know today, you can bet I'll be diving deep and telling you all about it soon.

At my core, I'm a Research & Developer. My expertise spans AI, IoT, Cloud Computing, DevOps, Networking, Full Stack Development, Telecommunications, and Cybersecurity—all packed into one. I thrive on problem-solving and seamlessly weaving technologies together. My fascination with technology began at an early age, and I see it not just as a career, but as my calling. It's both my duty and my passion. I'm always learning, always discovering, always optimizing. I love inventing, creating, and refining everything I touch.

As a bit of a visionary, I understand the importance of bridging the gap between the technical and the non-technical. I help startups navigate complexities, share knowledge and best practices, and ensure clear, realistic timelines.

And then, there's my obsession with documentation—it's built into my DNA. Everything I do, I document. Even my time. Because we can't manage time, only ourselves.

In my ever-growing toolbox, these three stand out:

- Python
- JavaScript
- Linux

<https://github.com/scholtde>

<https://rc.technology>

<https://edgetower.co.za>

Experience

RCT

AI Researcher, Innovator, Maker and Creator

March 2018 - Present (8 years 3 months)

Pretoria Area, South Africa

Consultations, new product development, prototyping and handing over solutions to customers which not only meet their needs, but also giving them something they never knew they actually wanted.

From an autonomous farm robot to laboratory automation equipment to AI to cyber security to IoT to Digital Marketing you name your requirement, I find a solution and I create a product.

Name the coding language, hardware platform, sensor, chip, framework, library, whatever it is, I'll learn it and use it.

Delivered successful solutions and prototypes to the following industries:

- Digital Marketing
- Physical Security
- Cyber Security
- Healthcare
- Research Laboratories
- Mining

Technologies (but not limited to):

- Python
- NodeJS
- Javascript
- C & C++
- Django, Flask, Sanic, FastAPI
- OpenCV
- Tensorflow, Caffe, Yolo
- PyQt5
- Redis
- MySQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, InfluxDB, Big Query
- Git
- Azure, Google Cloud, Heroku, AWS
- MQTT, Google PUB/SUB, any kind of Publish/Subscribe communication

Cybermarks

Cybersecurity Research & Developer

July 2021 - February 2022 (8 months)

Pretoria, Gauteng, South Africa

Cybermarks is a cybersecurity startup founded in July 2021. I helped to build out this company and also formed part of the leadership from a technical standpoint. I would define this as being the interface between senior management and technical aspects/requirements in order to achieve a set of deliverables.

My duties & responsibilities included:

- Technicalities behind building the brand (website, social media, back-offices)
- Technicalities behind building the product line & services
- Providing cybersecurity services to our Investor company (Consulting, SIEM Solutions, Reporting)
- Development & Deployment of full blown SIEM solution to our Investor company
- Converting of internal developments into a public service offering
- Chair technical meetings with industry partners, 3rd party cybersecurity consultants
- Progress updates & Presentations to management on technical developments
- Reporting

Research work:

- Research the best & most cost effective tool for the job. This included doing a market comparison of everything out there, and choosing the best tool to fit the budget.
- Cybersecurity products and industry partners
- Research cybersecurity practices, cybersecurity domains
- Cybersecurity policies, compliance, legal frameworks & requirements
- Tool integrations, white-labeling, and up-sell possibilities

Development work:

- Website
- Website back-office integration
- Tool API built with Python and the Sanic Framework integrating client facing back-office with the Cybersecurity tools.
- REST API integrations with 3rd party cybersecurity providers

Operations work:

- Distributed SIEM tool deployments on Investor company infrastructure
- Deployment of SIEM agents on company assets
- Server cluster management of distributed deployment using PROXMOX
- Firewall administration and access management

Technologies (but not limited to):

- Python, Sanic, Swagger, OpenAPI3
- Proxmox

Some product demos are available on request.

Health Solutions Africa

Senior Software Developer

February 2018 - April 2018 (3 months)

Sandton

Contracted to do software development, hardware design & development, research, IoT and automation

Technologies:

- .Net & C# and C
- MySQL

Projects included:

Emergency management systems.

Automated vehicle response systems.

Miscellaneous observation and response systems.

Naxian Systems

Innovation Engineer

October 2017 - February 2018 (5 months)

Sandton

I was called the Jimmy Neutron of Naxian. My position as innovation engineer involved research, development, documentation and implementation of AI(Artificial Intelligence) products which involved computer vision, object-recognition, facial recognition, human pose recognition, emotion recognition, speech recognition, etc. I delivered prototypes according to customer specification.

Technologies (but not limited to):

- Python
- C++
- OpenCV
- Tensorflow, Caffe, Yolo

RCT

Founder and Technologist

March 2017 - October 2017 (8 months)

Pretoria Area, South Africa

Web development, hosting services, IoT & networking systems, automation, autonomous vehicle systems, 3D printing, prototyping.

Technologies:

- Mission Planner
- QGround control
- Ardupilot
- Python, C & C++
- Solidworks
- Wordpress

Vodacom

12 years 8 months

Operations Specialist: Core Network Engineering

February 2008 - March 2017 (9 years 2 months)

Pretoria Area, South Africa

- Solve high-level customer related queries and network quality issues.
- Future network growth/roll-out/solutions and new technologies presentation
- Rel.4 network architecture maintenance and operation
- New technology implementation/integration/upgrade/testing
- Change Management and Coordination between multiple-departments ensuring successful cutovers

Data-Center Management (+3Million Subscriber base):

- Data-Center Projects, Roll-outs and Stakeholders
- Managed multiple-concurrent projects running at the same time during new technology roll-outs

Senior Technical Officer

February 2007 - January 2008 (1 year)

Pretoria Area, South Africa

Network quality measurement, maintain and ensure network performance, trend analysis and basic forecasting, planned system audits and health checks, implement performance management processes, proactive core network capacity planning, database audits & corrections, supervising

Switching Technical Officer

August 2005 - February 2007 (1 year 7 months)

Pretoria Area, South Africa

Duties & Responsibilities:

Reporting, routine maintenance, database administration, fault handling, patch implementations, database expansions, hardware upgrades, inventory management, system backups, contractor & supplier management during installations and upgrades, health & Safety representative, site management.

Bursary Student Intern

August 2004 - August 2005 (1 year 1 month)

Pretoria Area, South Africa

Education

Tshwane University of Technology

NDip Computer Systems Engineering, Systems Engineering · (2001 - 2005)

Varsity College

Diploma, Business Management · (2009 - 2010)

Lichtenburg High School

Matric, Computer Science · (1996 - 2000)